

MAT 5653 001

Differential Equations I

Course Syllabus - Spring 2026



Course Information

Course Description: Prerequisite: MAT 3613 and MAT 4213, or consent of instructor. Solution of initial-value problems, linear systems with constant coefficients, exponentials of operators, canonical forms and generic properties of operators, and contractions. This course has Differential Tuition. Course Fee: GS01 \$90.

Credit Hours: 3

Course Modality: Traditional in-person

Meeting Times

Duration: 01/20/2026-05/13/2026

Campus: Main Campus

Location: [MH 3.02.12](#)

Time(s): TR 7:30 PM - 8:45 PM

Learning Goals

At the end of the course, you will be able to:

grasp basic theory of system of the first order constant coefficient ordinary differential equations;
grasp the basic theory of existence, uniqueness and continuous dependence theorems.

Outcome

grasp the basic theory of well-posedness of ordinary differential equations; and dynamics of
system of the first order constant coefficient ordinary differential equations.

Skills Goals

At the end of the course, you will be able to:

grasp dynamics of system of the first order constant coefficient ordinary differential equations;
and the well-posedness theory

Communicate with Me

Instructor Name: Fengxin Chen

Department
Mathematics

Office Location
Flawn 4.02.58

Student Hours
TR 4:00 pm-5:00 pm or by appointment

Email Address: fengxin.chen@utsa.edu

Preferred Method of Communication
Use fengxin.chen@utsa.edu for communication. There is no phone in the office.

About Me & My Teaching Philosophy

I love teaching. I am awarded twice for teaching excellency from two different universities. My teaching goal is for student to experience the actual thinking process(es) of mathematicians when they invented/discovered mathematics.

Course Materials

Differential Equations and Dynamical Systems

ISBN: 978-0387951164

Authors: Lawrence Perko

To enhance your learning and adequately prepare for all assignments and assessments, please consider all course materials listed above, along with additional content provided in class, posted to our course site, or included in the Course Schedule, as required reading and study unless indicated as optional.

Additional Course Information

We will focus the first two chapters of the textbook. The first part will be the dynamics of flow defined by system of the first order ordinary differential equations. And the second part will cover the well-posedness of the initial value problems and then study the dynamics of the corresponding flow.

Assessments and Assignments

Your grade will be based on homework (20%), one midterm exam

(40%) and the final exam(40% each). Homework will be assigned each class day and students are

expected to finish it before the next class day. There will be no late or make-up work accepted for homework, exams, even if you add the class late, get sick, etc. However, total of 3 lowest quiz/homework scores will be dropped for every student. If you must be gone on an exam day, make arrangements with me at least two days before the exam date so that you can take it before you leave.

Activities and Grading

Activity	Quantity	%
Midterm exam	1	40
Homework	10	20
Final	1	40
Total		100%

Distribution of Course Assignments, Their Quantity, and Contribution to Final Grade.

Grade Distribution and Letter Grade

Grading Scales (by percentage):	
A+	95-100
A	90-95
A-	87-90
B+	83-87
B	77-83
B-	75-77
C+	73-75
C	68-73
C-	60-68
D+	55-60
D	50-55
D-	45-50
F	0-45

Course Guidelines for the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence

The Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence is allowed for learning purposes if it is helpful. But it is not allowed for homework and exams.

Course Expectations & Policies

Reading: It is important to read the text carefully before a given section is covered in class.

Come to class to follow the class schedule . Read a section all the way through once and then come back to points of interest.

Attendance: Attendance will not be taken but it is crucial for several reasons. First and foremost, you will gain a better understanding of the material by coming to class. Second, homework review will be given randomly during a week. In addition, changes in the syllabus or schedule may occur and will only be announced in class.

Instructor-Initiated Drops

This course will not adopt instructor-initiated drops.

Video and Audio Recording

As the instructor of this course, I may record meetings and lessons. You are expected to follow appropriate University policies and maintain the security of passwords used to access recorded lectures. Recordings may not be published, reproduced, or shared with those not in the class. If the instructor or a UTSA office plans any other uses for the recordings, consent of the students identifiable in the recordings is required before such use unless an exception is allowed by law. For more information on your privacy and class recordings, review [Student Privacy \(FERPA\) in Virtual Classrooms and Other Educational Recordings](#) and the [Guide to Secure Video Conferencing Tools](#).

Academic Freedom

Academic freedom¹ is a cornerstone of the University. Academic freedom in its teaching aspect is fundamental for the protection of the rights of the teacher in teaching and of the student to freedom in learning.² Each faculty member is entitled to full freedom in the classroom discussing the subject that the faculty member teaches.³ The University of Texas at San Antonio will not penalize or discipline members of the faculty because of their exercise of academic freedom.

Along with this freedom comes responsibility. It is the responsibility of faculty members to ensure that topics taught are related to the classroom subject. Students should be free to take reasoned exception to the data or views offered in any course of study and to reserve judgment about matters of opinion, but they are responsible for learning the content of any course of study for which they are enrolled.⁴ It is not the proper role of the university or any outside agency to attempt to shield individuals from ideas and opinions they find unwelcome, disagreeable, or even deeply offensive.⁵ Engaging with new ideas and perspectives helps students grow intellectually and is beneficial to the educational process.

- 1. Statement adapted from Texas A&M University's [Syllabus Statement Regarding Academic Freedom](#)
- 2. 1940 Statement of Principles on Academic Freedom and Tenure
- 3. Board of Regents Rule 31004; HOP Policy 4.02
- 4. American Association of University Professors Joint Statement on Rights and Freedoms of Students
- 5. The Chicago Statement

Syllabus Changes

The syllabus is subject to change at the instructor’s discretion. Any changes/corrections to the course materials, assignment dates, or other updates will be communicated to the students ahead of time. You are responsible for checking Canvas for corrections or updates to the syllabus.

Course Schedule

For a list of important university-wide dates, review [One Stop’s academic calendar](#).

Due Date	Activities/Assignments	Points
3/3/26	section 1.8	10
1/29/26	section 1.2	10
3/7/26	Texas DE Conference2026	100

Due Date	Activities/Assignments	Points
4/16/26	section 2.5 and 2.6	20
3/3/26	section 1.9	10
2/5/26	section 1.3	10
3/19/26	section 2.1	10
3/24/26	section 2.3	10
	section 1.6 and 1.7	10
1/29/26	Section 1.1	10
3/24/26	section 2.2	10
3/17/26	Midterm	100
	section 2.4	10
	Final part 2	70
2/5/26	section 1.4	10
2/8/26	section 1.5	10
4/30/26	Final Part 1	30

Department Policies & Resources

Ombudsperson

The ombudsperson is an advocate who investigates complaints about a specific section or instructor and attempts to resolve them through mediation. Comments or complaints sent to this person will be

brought to the attention of department leadership, who will follow up. If you have questions about the logistics of your class, please contact the instructor.

Contact Ilse Rosales Martinez at ilse.rosalesmartinez@utsa.edu

Tutoring Services

UTSA provides many opportunities for student success, including tutoring services for specific math courses. The list below is subject to change based on availability.

MAT 1023, MAT 1043, MAT 1053, and MAT 1073

- We offer peer-to-peer academic support to students enrolled in a variety of courses. Both drop-in tutoring and one-on-one appointments are available.
- **Location:** [Tomás Rivera Center for Academic Excellence](#) MS 2.02.18 (behind the Rowdy statue)

MAT 1053 and MAT 1073

- Synergistic Targeted Academic Review Sessions (STARS), peer-led, interactive, and group focused sessions which cover traditionally difficult topics. The schedule will be provided by instructors through Canvas.
- **Location:** Determined by STARS tutors

MAT 1093, MAT 1213/1214, and MAT 1223/1224

- The Math Gym is unique in that it's a WeBWork lab designed to offer our STEM core students support from math majors and minors through targeted SI sessions. The schedule will be provided by instructors through Canvas
- **Location:** [Math Gym FLN 03.02.08](#)

Note: Course-specific support for upper-division courses may be available for a particular semester. Please request this information from your instructor.

Essential Student Information

- **Important:** Bookmark and visit the [Common Syllabus Information webpage](#) to find important and valuable resources about counseling services, transitory/minor medical issues, supplemental instruction, tutoring services, academic success coaching, sexual harassment and sexual misconduct, campus safety and emergency preparedness, and the Roadrunner Creed.
- For technical requirements, support, and resources, visit [Academic Innovation's Student Technical Support](#) page.
- UT San Antonio provides reasonable accommodations to students via [Student Disability Services](#). For more details on eligibility, policies, and requirements, please visit [Applying for Accommodations](#) or call (210) 458-4157.
- Your well-being is important. In addition to academic growth, life as a student can include many emotional experiences and opportunities. Being mindful of your own needs and available support can provide you with the tools to successfully navigate these experiences. Student support for well-being, including [24/7 mental health services](#), can be accessed from the [Well-being at UT San Antonio](#) site for students. If needed, we can schedule a meeting, and I can connect you to resources. You are not alone; I am available to help you find resources that might best meet your needs.

- [Student Assistance Services \(SAS\)](#) is available to help you navigate academic and personal challenges. Campus Advocates in SAS are a central point of contact for students seeking clarity on university processes and policies. They also provide a direct connection to helpful resources and advocacy rooted in care. Campus Advocates offer confidential support and personalized guidance to help students succeed.
- The [Roadrunner Pantry](#) is here to help UT San Antonio students stay healthy and focused by providing free access to groceries, toiletries, and other essentials. With locations at the Main and Downtown campuses, the pantry is organized like a small store and offers items such as canned goods, snacks, and hygiene products. Students with a valid UTSA ID can visit the pantry to pick up what they need. Our goal is to ensure every Roadrunner feels supported and has the resources to succeed. If you're ever short on food or supplies, the Roadrunner Pantry is a welcoming space you can count on.
- Students at UT San Antonio are responsible for ensuring their work is consistent with UT San Antonio's standards for academic integrity. Students should review [Section 203 of the UT San Antonio Student Code of Conduct](#) for appropriate standards of academic integrity.
- UT San Antonio provides numerous services for students from counseling to tutoring to a food pantry. Visit [Student Affairs Programs and Services](#) and [Student Success](#) for more information.
- Visit the [UT San Antonio Libraries and Museums](#) site for access to journals, research tutorials, and tech gear you can borrow and to find your department's librarian.
- Enroll in the [Roadrunner Success Playbook](#), an open-enrollment, self-paced, online hub in Canvas tailored to ensure you have the resources you need to excel at UT San Antonio.
- Follow [Digital Learning Netiquette](#) standards for your online communication activities.